



COMPANION TOOLKIT

Rumblings of a Recruiter

A practical operating system for becoming known, findable, and steady inside the hiring machine.

Stop treating the job search as a submission problem. Treat it as a visibility, trust, and timing problem.

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Version 1.1 · 2026 · sajithkumarswaminathan.com



Start here

HOW TO USE THIS TOOLKIT

This toolkit turns the ideas in *Rumblings of a Recruiter* into repeatable action. The book names what the hiring machine does. This toolkit helps you decide what to do next.

- **Who it's for:** anyone running a real job search who is tired of applying into silence.
- **What it is:** a set of audits, scripts, and scorecards you fill in — not an article to skim.
- **Time:** ~20 minutes to read, then 30–45 minutes per week to run.
- **How to use it:** print it and write by hand, or fill the tables digitally. Both work.
- **The only rule that matters:** don't try to use everything. Pick **one tool** this week and run it. One tool used beats ten tools admired.

New to the search? Start with the *Candidate Signal Statement* and the *20-Person Visibility Map*. **Deep in a long search and drained?** Start with the *Search Energy Budget* and *Stop-Time Rule*.

Roar vs ROARS — read this once

Roar is the brand and the book: *Rumblings of a Recruiter*. **ROARS** is the five-step method inside this toolkit.

Step	The question it answers	
R	Read the Machine	What is actually happening before I blame myself?
O	Own Your Signal	What do I want to be known for, and where does it show up?
A	Activate Relationships	Who do I talk to <i>before</i> the role is crowded?
R	Reduce the Damage	How do I protect my energy, identity, and judgment?
S	Ship the Search	How do I track, measure, and adjust weekly?

The Roar Quick Card

One page. Tape it above your desk. If you do nothing else, do these five things.

If you're stuck on...	Run this tool	The move
Wasting energy on dead roles	Ghost Posting Check	Three+ red flags → no effort without a human conversation first.

If you're stuck on...	Run this tool	The move
Sounding generic	Candidate Signal Statement	One sentence: who you help, with what, when you're most valuable.
Applying into silence	20-Person Visibility Map	Be known by the right 20, not seen by everyone.
Burning out	Search Energy Budget	Cap draining activity <i>before</i> it caps you.
Feeling busy but not moving	Weekly Search Dashboard	Track signal, not effort. Adjust every Friday.

The one belief to hold: You can't control the machine. You **can** control your signal, your relationships, your proof, your pace, and your recovery.

R Read the Machine

UNDERSTAND WHAT IS HAPPENING BEFORE BLAMING YOURSELF

Hiring Reality Audit

Use this when a role looks attractive but unclear.

Question	Answer
Is this role newly posted, reposted, or evergreen?	
Does the job description name real work or mostly traits?	
Does the company appear to be actively hiring in this function?	
Can I identify the likely hiring manager or team lead?	
Do I know anyone one or two steps away from the team?	
Is there salary transparency or at least a likely range?	
Does the posting look like a real opening, a pipeline role, or a compliance posting?	
What evidence do I have, not just hope?	

Decision — choose one:

- **Apply only:** low interest, low access, acceptable loss.
- **Apply plus contact:** medium interest, possible human path.
- **Human first:** high interest, identifiable team, relationship path exists.
- **Skip:** weak signal, poor fit, bad process, or emotional cost too high.

Ghost Posting Check

Before spending real energy, check for these signals.

Signal	Yes / No
The role has been open more than 45 days.	
Similar roles have been reposted repeatedly.	
The description is generic and not tied to a team or project.	

Signal	Yes / No
The company recently announced layoffs, freezes, or restructuring.	
The role appears across many locations without clear ownership.	
Recruiters are advertising the role but cannot explain the work.	
Internal employees are not engaging with the posting.	

Scoring: If three or more are *Yes*, treat the role as uncertain. Do not over-invest without a human conversation first.



Own Your Signal

CLARIFY WHAT YOU WANT TO BE KNOWN FOR, AND WHERE IT APPEARS

Candidate Signal Statement

Fill this in before rewriting resumes, LinkedIn profiles, or outreach messages.

I help **[type of company/team]** solve **[specific problem]** by using **[your strongest capability]**, especially when **[situation where you are valuable]**.

Examples:

- I help early-stage SaaS teams clean up messy revenue operations by building simple reporting systems, especially when founders are still making decisions from spreadsheets.
- I help manufacturing companies modernize hiring by improving recruiter workflows, especially when applicant volume is high and hiring managers are overloaded.

Your draft

The Three-Proof Inventory

For every target role, collect three proofs.

Proof Type	Your Evidence
A measurable result	
A messy problem you handled	
A human or cross-functional challenge you navigated	

If you cannot fill all three, the resume will sound thin and the interview will drift into claims instead of evidence.

Resume Signal Check

Your resume should pass three readers.

Reader	What They Need	Pass?
Parser	Clear titles, dates, keywords, simple formatting	

Reader	What They Need	Pass?
Recruiter	Fast match to role, credible scope, no confusion	
Hiring manager	Evidence that you can do the actual work	

Rule: The top half of the resume should match the role. The bottom half should still sound like a person.

LinkedIn Findability Check

Item	Done
Headline says what you do, not just your job title.	
About section names your problem space.	
Featured section includes proof: writing, project, portfolio, case study, talk, or artifact.	
Experience bullets show outcomes, not only responsibilities.	
Skills match the language of target roles.	
Recent activity makes you visible to the right market.	

A Activate Relationships

BUILD CONVERSATIONS BEFORE ROLES OPEN, NOT AFTER THE POSTING IS CROWDED

Target Company List

Build a focused list before applying widely.

Company	Why this company?	Target function	Trigger event	Possible contact	Priority
					H / M / L
					H / M / L
					H / M / L

Trigger events include funding, expansion, leadership change, new product, new geography, regulatory change, acquisition, layoffs at competitors, or repeated postings.

The 20-Person Visibility Map

You do not need to know everyone. You need to be known by the right few.

Category	Names
5 people doing the job I want	
5 hiring managers or team leads	
5 connectors, recruiters, or community people	
5 peers who share market intelligence	

Your weekly goal is not to "network." It is to create useful contact with this map.

Warm Outreach Script

Subject: Quick question about your work at **[Company]**

Hi **[Name]**,

I came across your work on **[specific project/team/post/company move]** and wanted to ask a practical question.

I am exploring roles where I can help with **[problem space]**. From the outside, it looks like your team may be dealing with **[specific challenge]**.

Would you be open to a 15-minute conversation? I am not asking you to refer me. I am trying to understand the work more clearly before I decide where to focus.

Thanks,
[Your Name]

Recruiter Clarity Script

Use this early, before investing heavily.

Thanks for reaching out. Before we go too far, can I ask three quick questions?

1. Is this role approved and actively moving, or is it more exploratory?
2. What problem is the hiring manager trying to solve in the first six months?
3. What range has been budgeted for the role?

If the recruiter cannot answer any of these, proceed carefully.

Hiring Manager Conversation Questions

- What has made this role hard to fill or hard to define?
- What would the person need to fix, build, or stabilize in the first 90 days?
- What would make you say, six months from now, that this was clearly the right hire?
- What is not written in the job description that matters?
- Where have strong candidates missed the mark so far?

R Reduce the Damage

PROTECT ENERGY, IDENTITY, AND DECISION QUALITY DURING THE SEARCH

Search Energy Budget

A long search is not only a logistics problem. It is an identity and energy problem.

Activity	Weekly limit	Actual
Cold applications		
Tailored applications		
Human outreach		
Networking calls		
Interview preparation		
LinkedIn scrolling		
Recovery time		

Rule: If an activity repeatedly drains you and produces no signal, reduce it before it reduces you.

Rejection Debrief

Do this once, then move on.

Question	Answer
Did I have enough information to judge fit?	
Did I reach a human or only a portal?	
Did I lose because of fit, timing, process, compensation, or unknown reasons?	
Is there one useful adjustment to make?	
What should I not over-learn from this?	

Anti-spiral rule: Do not turn a silent rejection into a full theory of your worth.

Stop-Time Rule

Before checking email, job boards, LinkedIn, or application portals, decide when you will stop.

Activity	Start	Stop	Why I am doing this

If you cannot name why you are checking, you are probably soothing anxiety, not advancing the search.

Ship the Search

TRACK ACTIONS, MEASURE CONVERSION, ADJUST WEEKLY, AND KEEP MOVING

Weekly Search Dashboard

Track the search as a system.

Metric	This week	Last week	Notes
Target companies added			
Human messages sent			
Conversations booked			
Referrals or warm intros			
Applications submitted			
Interviews booked			
Follow-ups sent			
Offers / late-stage processes			
Energy level, 1–10			

What to look for:

- Applications high, conversations low → shift toward people.
- Conversations high, interviews low → sharpen your signal.
- Interviews high, offers low → improve proof and closing.
- Energy falling for two weeks → reduce volume and increase recovery.

Application Triage

Use this before applying.

Factor	Score 0–2
I understand the actual work.	
I can identify the hiring manager or team.	

Factor	Score 0–2
I have a credible proof story for the role.	
I can reach someone connected to the company.	
The posting appears real and current.	
The compensation is likely workable.	
The role is worth emotional investment.	

Decision:

- **10–14:** Apply and pursue a human path.
- **6–9:** Apply only if effort is low or interest is high.
- **0–5:** Skip unless there is a strong hidden reason.

Weekly Review — answer every Friday

1. What created actual signal this week?
2. What only created the feeling of productivity?
3. Which company or person should I go deeper with?
4. What am I avoiding because it feels exposed?
5. What will I stop doing next week?
6. What is the smallest action that would make me more findable?



The Work-Proof Answer

Use this structure instead of generic STAR answers.

Part	Prompt
Context	What was messy, unclear, or at stake?
Judgment	What did you notice that others missed?
Action	What did you actually do?
Tradeoff	What did you choose not to do?
Result	What changed because of your work?
Relevance	Why does this matter for this role?

90-Day Value Map

Bring this thinking into final interviews.

Period	Focus	Evidence to gather	Likely contribution
Days 1–30	Learn the system		
Days 31–60	Fix visible friction		
Days 61–90	Build repeatable value		

Questions That Signal Seniority

- What decision will this hire make easier for you?
- What is the cost of not solving this problem in the next six months?
- Where does this role have influence, and where does it only have responsibility?
- What would make someone technically qualified but still wrong for this role?
- What should I understand about the team before deciding whether I can do my best work here?



Negotiation Toolkit

GET TO A CLEAR, CONFIDENT COUNTER

Offer Readiness Checklist

Item	Done
I know the salary range or likely band.	
I understand bonus, equity, commission, or variable pay.	
I understand benefits, vacation, remote policy, and work hours.	
I know the start date expectation.	
I have the offer in writing before resigning.	
I have identified what matters most besides salary.	
I have prepared one clear counter, not a scattered list.	

Compensation Conversation Script

I am excited about the role and the problems you are trying to solve. Based on the scope we have discussed and the market for similar roles, I was expecting something closer to **[range]**. Is there flexibility to get nearer to that?

If they say no:

I understand. Are there other parts of the package we can revisit, such as signing bonus, review timing, vacation, remote flexibility, or professional development?

30 The RoaR 30-Day Search Sprint

ONE MONTH, FOUR MOVES

Week	Do this
Week 1 — Clarity	Write your candidate signal statement · build a 25-company target list · clean your resume for parser, recruiter, and hiring manager · update LinkedIn for findability · choose 10 people for your visibility map.
Week 2 — Conversations	Send 10 specific outreach messages · book 3 informational conversations · ask 2 recruiters the clarity questions · publish or share one useful work-related insight.
Week 3 — Proof	Build three work-proof stories · prepare a 90-day value map for one target role · apply to no more than 10 roles, all triaged · ask for one warm introduction.
Week 4 — Review	Review conversion data · cut low-yield activity · deepen two promising relationships · refresh your target list · decide the next 30-day experiment.

Reader Promise

The goal of this toolkit is not to make the search painless. It is to make it less blind.

You cannot control whether a company is serious, whether a recruiter is overloaded, whether a hiring manager changes their mind, or whether a role disappears behind a budget conversation you will never hear.

You can control your signal, your relationships, your proof, your pace, and your recovery. **That is the work.**

Before you close this

You don't need all of it. Pick **one tool** — the *Application Triage*, or the *20-Person Visibility Map* — and run it this week. One tool used beats ten tools admired.

If it helped, three things make it travel further:

- 1 **Run one tool and tell me which one.** I read the replies, and your win helps the next person searching in the dark.
- 2 **Found this from a post? Comment “Roar”** and I'll send the toolkit to anyone who asks.
- 3 **Want the full system** — the stories, the hiring-machine patterns, and the *why* behind every move here? It's in the book, *Rumblings of a Recruiter*.

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